

**JQ GUI**

To build “rich” web applications, use jQuery UI—a jQuery plugin that lets you create animations and interactions similar to desktop applications

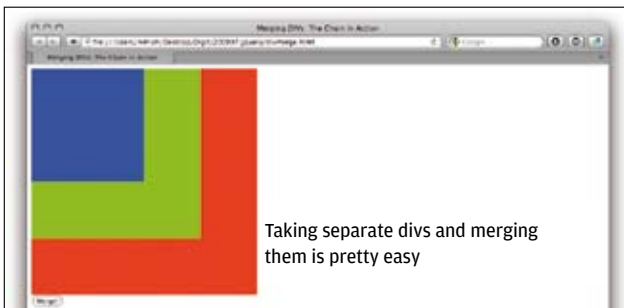
**Get started**

You can try one of the hundreds of plugins available for it at [plugins.jquery.com](http://plugins.jquery.com)

Modifying styles and layouts is powerful and fun, but not as much fun as watching that happen with animation.

**The jQuery Effect**

jQuery comes bundled with all sorts of special effects for your (and



your visitors’) entertainment. It all starts with the simple “show ()” and “hide ()” functions:

```
$ ('#someID').show();
$ ('#someID').hide();
```

which can also be animated, if you like:

```
$ ('#someID').show('fast');
$ ('#someID').hide('slow');
```

You don’t, however, want to check whether an element is visible or hidden to decide which function to use, so you use “toggle ()” instead—as the name suggests, it’ll hide a visible element, or show a hidden one. It, too, can be animated:

```
$ ('#someID').toggle('slow');
```

And when you’re done playing with special effects, you can try your hand at some basic AJAX.

**From The Beyond**

This is the simplest form of AJAX—getting information from another

page, without reloading your current one. Our external data, in this case, will be an XML file (it could be PHP or HTML, for that matter). Technically, since this doesn’t involve the XMLHttpRequest object, it’s only AJAX in the loosest sense of the term.

Here’s the type of data we’ve got in the XML file:

```
<software>
  <Title>8 Kingdoms</Title>
  <Description>8 Kingdoms is a 3D turn-
    based fantasy strategic game in which players
    become kings, build their empires and conquer
    enemy kingdoms.</Description>
  <License>Free</License>
  <Section>Gaming</Section>
  <Category>Free Games</Category>
  <Size>34.6 MB</Size>
  <Path>Gaming\Games\8Kingdoms-1.1.0.exe</
Path>
  <Month>June</Month>
  <Year>2008</Year>
  <Media>Freeware</Media>
</software>
```

And here’s what our HTML looks like:

```
<div class="ajax stuff">
  <h1>AJAX!</h1>
  <input type="submit" value="Load Info"
id="ajaxgetter"/>
  <!--This div waits for the content-->
  <div id="ajaxinfo">
    </div>
</div>
And finally, this is the JavaScript that gets it all done :
$ ("#ajaxgetter").click( function() {
    $ ("#ajaxinfo").
load("sample.xml");
});
```

**The result:**

The “load ()” function will bring up whatever you pass to it—you could even load entire websites in that little space. You can also submit forms using “\$.get ()” and “\$.post ()” (for the GET and POST methods respectively), and show the results in your AJAX area.

```
.end();
```

If you’ve been wanting to try AJAX but were daunted by JavaScript, jQuery is your thing. If you’ve been using JavaScript for AJAX so far, you can leave that mess behind and make your code lighter with jQuery. Most important of all, though, jQuery brings simple JavaScripting to the hands of web designers, and that’s something we’ve waited for for too long. 

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AND WIN.

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